

Absolutely — **spring** is a very strong polysemy target because your passage uses it inside **spring onions**, while the same word also means **the season**, **a coil/device**, **a source of water**, and has several important verb meanings such as **jump suddenly**, **arise**, **appear**, and **originate**.

Word family: **spring / sprang / sprung / springing / springy / springtime / springboard**

Base word: **spring**

Past tense: **sprang**

Past participle: **sprung**

-ing form: **springing**

Related forms: **springy, springtime**

Useful lexical extensions: **springboard, spring onion, spring water, hot spring, spring cleaning**

Part of speech: **noun (名詞) / verb (動詞) / adjective-related forms (相關形容詞)**

Your sentence:

> “For vegetables, she often grows lettuce, cherry tomatoes, **spring onions**, and chilli peppers.”

Meaning in your passage: **spring onion = 蔥 ; 青蔥**

Here, **spring** is part of the compound **spring onion**.

It does **not** mean simply “an onion that grows in spring.”

Spring onion refers to a young onion harvested before the bulb fully develops, commonly used with its green stalks.

繁體中文 :

尚未完全長成大型洋蔥球莖、連同綠色葉柄食用的嫩蔥 ; 青蔥 / 蔥

Natural translation:

> “She often grows lettuce, cherry tomatoes, spring onions, and chilli peppers.”

「她經常種生菜、車厘茄、**蔥 / 青蔥**和辣椒。」

So:

> **spring onion = 蔥 / 青蔥**

Regional note:

* **spring onion** — common British English

* **green onion / scallion** — common North American English, depending on region

1. **spring = season between winter and summer (季節) — 春天 ; 春季**

The central everyday noun meaning.

Practice 1

> “The flowers begin to grow in **spring**.”

「花朵在**春天**開始生長。」

Practice 2

> “We usually plant tomatoes in early **spring**.”

「我們通常在**初春**種番茄。」

spring = 冬季之後、夏季之前的季節，常與天氣回暖和植物重新生長有關

2. **springtime = spring season — 春天 ; 春季**

A useful related form.

Practice 3

> “The garden is beautiful in **springtime**.”

「花園在**春天**非常漂亮。」

Practice 4

> “Many plants flower during springtime.”

「很多植物在**春季**開花。」

springtime = spring season，語氣稍具描寫性 / 抒情感

3. **spring = elastic coil/device (機械) — 彈簧**

A major distinct noun meaning.

Practice 5

> “The door contains a strong ****spring****.”

「那扇門裡有一個強力****彈簧****。」

Practice 6

> “The spring in the pen is broken.”

「筆裡的****彈簧****壞了。」

****spring — mechanism = 受壓或拉伸後能恢復原來形狀、用來儲存和釋放機械能的彈性裝置****

4. ****spring = natural source of water (自然水源) — 泉 ; 泉水源頭****

A genuinely distinct noun meaning.

Practice 7

> “A clear ****spring**** flows from the hillside.”

「山坡上流出一道清澈的****泉水****。」

Practice 8

> “The village was built near a natural spring.”

「村莊建在一處天然****泉源****附近。」

****spring — water = 地下水自然湧出地面的泉源 / 泉眼****

5. ****hot spring (地熱) — 溫泉****

A very common compound.

Practice 9

> “The town is famous for its ****hot springs****.”

「這個城鎮以**溫泉**聞名。」

Practice 10

> “We relaxed in a hot spring after hiking.”

「遠足後，我們在**溫泉**裡放鬆。」

hot spring = 由地下自然湧出、溫度較高的地熱泉水

6. **spring water (飲用水) — 泉水**

Practice 11

> “The bottle contains natural **spring water**.”

「瓶裡裝的是天然**泉水**。」

Practice 12

> “They collected spring water from the mountain.”

「他們從山上採集**泉水**。」

spring water = 來自天然地下泉源的水

7. **spring = sudden jump/leap (動詞) — 跳起；躍起；突然彈起**

Now **spring** is a verb.

Practice 13

> “The cat **sprang** onto the wall.”

「那隻貓突然**跳上**牆。」

Practice 14

> “He sprang to his feet when he heard the noise.”

「他聽到聲音後突然**站起來 / 一躍而起**。」

****spring — verb = 以快速、有彈性的動作突然跳動或移動****

Important irregular forms:

> spring → sprang → sprung

8. ****spring = move suddenly from a position (突然移動 / 彈開) — 突然跳出；彈開****

Practice 15

> “The door ****sprang open****.”

「門突然****彈開了****。」

Practice 16

> “The lid sprang shut.”

「蓋子突然****彈回關上****。」

****spring = 因彈力或突然動作而快速改變位置****

This is closely related to #7.

9. ****spring from + source/origin (來源) — 源自；起源於****

A very important figurative meaning.

Practice 17

> “Her love of gardening ****sprang from**** childhood memories.”

「她對園藝的喜愛****源自****童年回憶。」

Practice 18

> “The idea sprang from a simple conversation.”

「這個想法****源自****一次簡單的對話。」

****spring from = 某事物突然 / 自然地從某個來源、原因或背景產生****

This is a phrasal/prepositional construction, but it is important enough to flag because it reflects a genuine origin sense of **spring**.

10. **spring up** = appear suddenly / develop quickly — 突然出現；迅速冒起

Normally our standing rule excludes phrasal verbs, so I will only flag this briefly rather than expand it fully.

> **new cafés sprang up everywhere**

= 新咖啡店到處**迅速冒起**

It is common and semantically important, but best treated as a separate phrasal-verb lesson if needed.

11. **spring** = originate / arise (事情) — 產生；出現

Without a preposition, literary/formal uses can still express emergence.

Practice 19

> “New ideas **spring** from curiosity.”

「新的想法會從好奇心中**產生**。」

Practice 20

> “Hope can spring from difficult experiences.”

「希望也可以從艱難經歷中**萌生**。」

spring — figurative = 某種想法、情感或現象自然 / 突然出現

12. **springy** = elastic / bouncy (材質) — 有彈性的；彈力十足的

A useful related adjective.

Practice 21

> “The mattress feels soft and **springy**.”

「這張床褥柔軟而且**很有彈性**。」

Practice 22

> “The grass felt springy underfoot.”

「腳下的草地感覺**柔軟有彈性**。」

****springy = 受壓後會回彈，或觸感有彈性的****

13. ****springy = lively/bouncy in movement (步伐) — 輕快有彈性的****

Practice 23

> “She walked with a ****springy**** step.”

「她步伐**輕快而有彈性**。」

Practice 24

> “The dancer’s movements were light and springy.”

「舞者的動作輕盈而**富有彈性**。」

****springy — movement = 動作輕快、有彈跳感****

This is a contextual extension of elasticity.

14. ****springboard = board used for jumping/diving — 跳板****

A useful lexical extension.

Practice 25

> “The diver jumped from the ****springboard****.”

「跳水運動員從**跳板**起跳。」

Practice 26

> “The gymnast pushed off from the springboard.”

「體操運動員從**跳板**發力起跳。」

springboard — literal = 具有彈性的板，用來協助跳躍或跳水

15. **springboard = starting point/opportunity for further success (比喻) — 跳板；起點**

A major figurative extension.

Practice 27

> “The internship became a **springboard** for her career.”

「那次實習成為她職業生涯的**跳板 / 起點**。」

Practice 28

> “The competition gave him a springboard into professional sport.”

「那場比賽成為他進入職業體壇的**跳板**。」

springboard — figurative = 幫助某人進一步發展、成功或進入更高階段的起點 / 機會

16. **spring onion (蔬菜) — 蔥；青蔥**

Your exact source compound.

Practice 29 — Original

> “She grows lettuce, cherry tomatoes, **spring onions**, and chilli peppers.”

「她種生菜、車厘茄、**蔥**和辣椒。」

Practice 30

> “Chop the spring onions finely.”

「把**蔥**切碎。」

Practice 31

> “Spring onions add a fresh flavour to the dish.”

「**青蔥**能為菜式增添清新的味道。」

spring onion = 未完全成熟、通常連綠色葉柄一起食用的嫩洋蔥 / 蔥類

17. **spring cleaning (家務) — 大掃除 ; 春季大清潔**

A common lexicalized compound.

Practice 32

> “We did some **spring cleaning** at the weekend.”

「我們週末做了**大掃除**。」

Practice 33

> “Spring cleaning usually involves clearing out old things.”

「**大掃除**通常包括清理舊物。」

spring cleaning = 對家居進行徹底清潔、整理和清除舊物的大型清潔活動

Historically associated with spring, but it can be used more broadly.

18. **a spring in one's step (精神狀態) — 步伐輕快 ; 精神奕奕**

A useful idiom.

Practice 34

> “She had a **spring in her step** after seeing the first flowers bloom.”

「看到第一批花開後，她走路都**輕快起來 / 精神奕奕**。」

Practice 35

> “Good news put a spring in his step.”

「好消息令他**精神振奮、步伐都輕快起來**。」

a spring in someone's step = 因心情好、精力充沛而走路顯得輕快有活力

This grows from the physical bounce sense.

Important distinction: **spring** vs summer/autumn/winter

As a season:

> spring = 春天
> summer = 夏天
> autumn/fall = 秋天
> winter = 冬天

Note capitalization:

> **spring** is normally lowercase in English unless at the start of a sentence or part of a proper name.

Important distinction: **spring** vs source

spring

literal:

a natural source of groundwater.

source

broader:

origin of anything.

> a spring of water
> = 泉源

> source of information
> = 資料來源

You cannot normally use **spring** for every kind of source.

Important distinction: **spring** vs well

You curated **well** earlier.

spring

= groundwater naturally emerges at the surface.

well

= a hole/shaft dug or drilled to reach groundwater.

So:

> spring = 天然泉源

> well = 井

Important distinction: **spring vs jump**

jump

general verb for leaving the ground.

spring

suggests:

* suddenness;

* quick elastic force;

* energetic movement.

> “The cat jumped onto the wall.”

neutral.

> “The cat sprang onto the wall.”

more vivid: **突然一躍而上**.

Important distinction: **spring vs bounce**

spring

can describe one sudden elastic movement.

bounce

usually involves rebounding after hitting a surface, often repeatedly.

> spring open

> = 彈開

> ball bounces

> = 球彈跳

Important distinction: **spring from vs come from**

come from

neutral origin.

> “The idea came from experience.”

spring from

more vivid/literary:

arise naturally or suddenly from a source.

> “The idea sprang from experience.”

「這個想法源自經驗。」

Important distinction: **spring onion vs onion**

onion

usually refers to the mature bulb vegetable.

spring onion

is harvested young and typically has:

* long green stalks;

* a small/underdeveloped bulb.

Natural Chinese depends on regional usage, but:

> spring onion = 蔥 / 青蔥

is appropriate for your passage.

Important distinction: ****spring onion vs scallion vs green onion****

These terms overlap, with regional differences.

****spring onion****

especially common British English.

****scallion / green onion****

especially common North American English.

Depending on region, ****spring onion**** may sometimes imply a slightly more developed bulb than ****scallion****, but everyday usage overlaps heavily.

For your vocabulary project:

> ****spring onion = 蔥 / 青蔥****

is the clean learner-level mapping.

Important distinction: ****springboard literal vs figurative****

Literal:

> springboard in diving/gymnastics

> = 跳板

Figurative:

> a springboard for a career

> = 職業發展的跳板

Same metaphor:

> physical launch → figurative launch into progress

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern family includes:

* **spring — season** = 春天
* **springtime** = 春季
* **spring — mechanical coil** = 彈簧
* **spring — water source** = 泉 / 泉源
* **hot spring** = 溫泉
* **spring water** = 泉水
* **spring — jump** = 一躍而起
* **spring — sudden movement** = 彈開 / 突然移動
* **spring — figurative emergence** = 萌生 / 產生
* **spring from** = 源自
* **springy — elastic** = 有彈性的
* **springy — movement** = 輕快有彈性的
* **springboard — literal** = 跳板
* **springboard — figurative** = 發展跳板
* **spring onion** = 蔥 / 青蔥
* **spring cleaning** = 大掃除
* **a spring in one's step** = 精神奕奕 / 步伐輕快

I would stop there rather than bring in obscure geological, mechanical, or historical compounds unless a later passage requires them.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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spring — season	冬季之後、夏季之前，常與天氣回暖及植物重新生長相關的季節
springtime	春季；語氣稍具描寫性或抒情感
spring — mechanism	受壓 / 拉伸後能恢復形狀並儲存、釋放機械能的彈簧
spring — water source	地下水自然湧出地面的泉源 / 泉眼
hot spring	地下自然湧出、溫度較高的地熱泉水
spring water	來自天然地下泉源的水
spring — jump	以快速、有彈性的動作突然跳動 / 躍起
spring — sudden movement	因彈力或突然動作而迅速改變位置
spring — figurative	某種想法、情感或現象自然 / 突然萌生或出現
spring from	某事物從某個來源、原因或背景產生 / 起源
springy — material	受壓後能回彈、具有彈性的
springy — movement	動作或步伐輕快、有彈跳感的
springboard — literal	用來協助跳躍 / 跳水的彈性跳板

springboard — figurative	幫助某人進一步發展或成功的起點 / 跳板	
spring onion	尚未完全長成大球莖、連綠色葉柄食用的嫩蔥 / 青蔥	
spring cleaning	對家居進行徹底清潔、整理和清除舊物的大掃除	
spring in one's step	因心情愉快 / 精力充沛而步伐輕快、精神奕奕	

For your original sentence

> “She often grows lettuce, cherry tomatoes, **spring onions**, and chilli peppers.”

The exact meaning is:

**spring 在這裡不是獨立表示「春天」，而是固定蔬菜名稱 spring onion 的一部分。 **

So:

> **spring onion**

= **「蔥 / 青蔥」**

Natural full translation:

> **「她經常種生菜、車厘茄、蔥和辣椒。」**

And the high-value contrasts are:

> **spring** → 春天

> **spring** → 彈簧

> **spring** → 泉 / 泉源

> **spring** → 一躍而起

> **spring from** → 源自

> **spring onion** → 蔥

> **springboard** → 跳板 / 比喻發展跳板